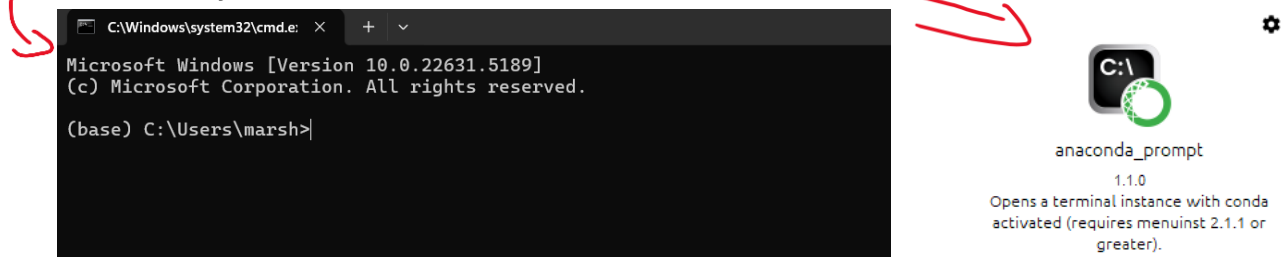


Starting CoMOLA on your personal Desktop:

1. Clone the repository from GitHub on the local desktop (or, if provided, directly download the CoMOLA files on your desktop)
2. Download Anaconda/Miniconda on your desktop and sign up with a free account
3. Launch anaconda_prompt.

This is what you'll see:



4. Now, we change the working directory to where our CoMOLA folder is. We write: `cd <path to the CoMOLA folder>`
Note: If the CoMOLA folder is in a different drive, you might have to change the drive first before changing the working directory. You can simply do it by writing D: or E: or F: and pressing enter.
5. Now, we'll create a conda environment with all the dependencies via running the python script: `python import_dependencies.py`
This will create an environment called comolaenv
6. Lets activate our environment: `conda activate comolaenv`

```
(base) C:\Users\marsh\Documents\CoMOLA>conda activate comolaenv  
(comolaenv) C:\Users\marsh\Documents\CoMOLA>
```

7. Finally lets check python and R paths within the environment, we need them in our config.ini files.

where R

```
(comolaenv) C:\Users\marsh\Documents\CoMOLA>where R  
C:\Users\marsh\anaconda3\envs\comolaenv\Scripts\R.exe
```

where python

```
(comolaenv) C:\Users\marsh\Documents\CoMOLA>where python  
C:\Users\marsh\anaconda3\envs\comolaenv\python.exe
```

8. Open config.ini files via: `notepad config.ini`
9. Change the R and python paths in the config.ini file to your comola environment paths and save the file:

```
[config_model]  
  
file_path_R = C:\Users\marsh\anaconda3\envs\comolaenv\Scripts\R.exe  
file_path_Python = C:\Users\marsh\anaconda3\envs\comolaenv\python.exe
```

10. You can adjust population size, maximum number of generations in the config.ini file.

Note: when starting for the first time make sure start_from_previous_gen is False

```
[config_optimization_algorithm]

pop_size = 5
max_generations = 10
mutation_rate = 0.01
crossover_rate = 0.9
priority = True
maximize = True
extreme_seeds = False
max_repair_trials = 10000
start_from_previous_gen = False
```

11. Now, lets run our optimization: `python __init__.py`

```
(como1aenv) C:\Users\marsh\Documents\CoMOLA>python __init__.py|
```

12. Hooray! Now we have a running CoMOLA optimization.